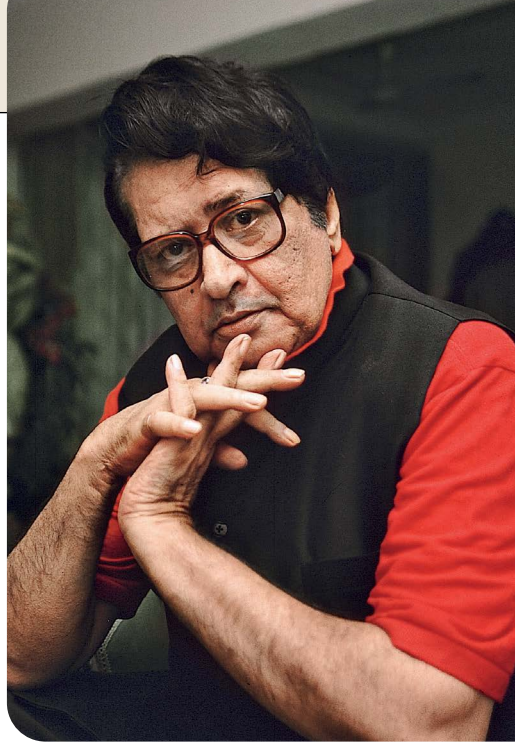


MANOJ KUMAR | b. 1937 |

Actor-director

Among the many who washed up in Bombay with clean-cut good looks and big dreams back in the '50s, Manoj Kumar was one who managed to endure and thrive—partly by transitioning to a role beyond the mannered tragic romance staples of the B&W era. An early turn in *Shaheed* (1965) showed the path, and he never looked back from a patriot act that was all his. Drafted, legislated, directed by—and starring—'Mr Bharat', as he came to be called. Of course, *Upkar*, *Roti Kapda aur Makaan*, *Kranti* et al were as Bollywood in design and intent as his smoke-filled hits like *Woh Kaun Thi*, *Gumnaam* and *Dus Numbri*.



NIRAV DAVE



GETTY IMAGES

GOPICHAND HINDUJA | b. 1940 |

Chairman, Hinduja Group

When Gopichand Hinduja died in November at 85, he was listed as Britain's richest man. The second eldest of the four Hinduja brothers, he helped transform a family enterprise into a sprawling global conglomerate employing about 200,000 people, with a combined net worth of $45 billion as of May 2025. Following the death of the eldest brother Srichand Hinduja in 2023, Gopichand took over as chairman of the Hinduja Group, whose footprints spanned automotive major Ashok Leyland, IndusInd Bank, Gulf Oil, Hinduja Global Solutions, and interests across power, healthcare and real estate.

ZUBEEN GARG | b. 1972 |

Singer

Zubeen Garg was never merely a singer. He was a temperament. Rooted in Assam, restlessly global in influence, he fused folk memory with rock, blues and political conscience. His voice carried both rebellion and tenderness, often in the same breath, giving dignity to linguistic and regional margins at a time when popular culture preferred uniformity. He was stubbornly independent and frequently at odds with institutions and expectations, which only deepened his bond with listeners. In an age of manufactured celebrity, Garg remained defiantly human.

